

IAN THOMAS WHITE ○ COMPUTATIONAL LINGUIST & WRITER

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OVERVIEW

I am an academically trained linguist with substantial tech-industry experience. I have training in all linguistic subfields, with a focus on formal language theory, and I've leveraged my linguistics training at ML/AI companies. I'm a rigorous problem-solver across both quantitative (Python, SQL, Haskell) and qualitative (writing, annotation, ontology) domains.

PROFICIENCIES

PROGRAMMING	LINGUISTICS	LANGUAGES	SKILLS
Git, Haskell, JSON, $\LaTeX$, Markdown, MS 365, NLTK, Notion, Python, PyTorch, Prompt Engineering, R, SQL	Computational, Grammar, Lexical, Morphology, NLP, Phonology, Pragmatics, Semantics, Syntax	French, Greek (Ancient), Latin (Classical)	Communication, Data Analysis & Annotation, Ontology, Research, Statistics, Taxonomy, Technical Writing

EXPERIENCE

LINGUISTICS TRAINER AND QA SPECIALIST, HUMAN DATA @ SpaceXAI: 08.2024-08.2026

- Annotated textual and visual/audio LLM outputs for adherence to phonological, syntactical, and semantic norms.
- Conducted model evaluation and QA for Python and SQL outputs.
- Wrote novel guidance and QA rubrics in Markdown, JSON, and Excel.
- Collaborated with engineers to ensure labeling guidelines accorded with machine learning principles and goals.
- Trained new tutors and developed algorithmic processes to improve tutor workflow and inter-annotator agreement.

LINGUISTICS INSTRUCTOR @ UCLA: 09.2022-12.2023

- Taught weekly seminars covering major linguistic subfields: phonology, morphology, syntax, semantics, pragmatics.
- Developed unique teaching materials and technical documentation using $\LaTeX$ and Haskell.
- Evaluated student performance and conducted regular one-on-one meetings with students.

COMPUTATIONAL LINGUIST @ App Orchid: 06.2021-09.2022

- Designed syntactic-tree-based regexes to match complex, embedded legal phrases in an LLM pipeline.
- Labeled and taxonomized linguistic regularities in legal corpora for POS, NER, and dependency/constituency parsing.
- Researched string parsing techniques to optimize regex search algorithms.
- Integrated regexes into the LLM pipeline using Python, SQL, and Git and wrote accompanying technical documentation.
- Communicated regularly with engineers, clients, and other stakeholders to ensure optimal ML outcomes.

LITERATURE INSTRUCTOR @ University of Minnesota: 09.2016-05.2020

- Designed and implemented syllabi for key departmental courses on literary theory.
- Wrote from scratch unique teaching materials on grammar and rhetoric.

EDUCATION

PHD (INCOMPLETE), LINGUISTICS @ UCLA: 2020-2023

- Took graduate courses in all linguistic subfields, as well as in algorithms and formal language theory.
- Researched and wrote on the generative capacities of Combinatory Categorical Grammars and Minimalist Grammars.
- Applied research toward NLP/NLU applications using Python and Haskell.

MA, LINGUISTICS @ University of Minnesota: 2016-2020

- Thesis: "The Argument Structure of Deverbal Nouns".
- Took graduate courses in all linguistic subfields: phonology, syntax, semantics, pragmatics, computational.
- Completed corpora analysis projects using Python, NLTK, and Google Colab.

MA, LITERATURE @ University of Minnesota: 2016-2020

- Thesis: "Discrete Infinity in Penelope's Weaving Trick".
- Took graduate courses in literary theory, French-language poetry, and Greek-language literature.
- Used APA, MLA, and Chicago manuals of style to write papers.

BA, WRITING @ Johns Hopkins University: 2008-2011

- Thesis: "Modern Mimesis: Alt-lit and Autofiction".